



A security hook that crashes lets the command run

Per Claude Code's docs, a failed hook is non-blocking and the action goes ahead. Only exit 2, or one newer setting, stops it.

SWIPE 

Five outcomes. Only one of them blocks.

Per the docs: a hook that can't start, exits 1, prints invalid JSON or times out lets the action go ahead. Exit 2 blocks.

01

WON'T START:
PROCEEDS

02

EXIT 1: PROCEEDS

03

BAD JSON:
PROCEEDS

04

TIMEOUT:
PROCEEDS

05

EXIT 2: BLOCKED

■ NO. 03 · THE SETTING

onFailure block flips the default

Set onFailure to block on a command or HTTP hook and a failure stops the action. The default is continue. It requires Claude Code v2.1.295 or later.

2.1.295+

NEEDED FOR ONFAILURE BLOCK

• DEFAULT: CONTINUE

• COMMAND AND HTTP
HOOKS

My approval hook answers before Claude Code cancels it

Pattern match, dashboard card, poll for up to 300 seconds, deny on the deadline. The hook timeout is 330, so my script answers first.



■ NO. 05 · AN HONEST GAP

Where my own hook is still open

If stdin can't be parsed, the script allows. By my reading of the docs, a crash exits 1 and the command runs. Not observed, not tested.

```
$ STDIN UNREADABLE: ALLOW

$ UNCAUGHT CRASH: EXIT 1

$ DOCS READING: COMMAND RUNS

$ STATUS: NOT OBSERVED

> NEXT: ONFAILURE BLOCK ■
```

Before you trust a hook as a gate

Use exit 2 for policy. Decide what failure does. Watch the first run for a hook error notice, because a mistyped path means it never runs.



POLICY HOOK USES EXIT 2

PASS



FAILURE BEHAVIOR DECIDED

PASS



NO RELIANCE ON TIMEOUTS

PASS



FIRST RUN CHECKED FOR ERRORS

LIVE



Decide what happens when the gate breaks

Set the failure behavior on purpose, then test that path.

SAVE THE GATE CHECKLIST